

PPS 2031

THE FUNDED PROMISE

A Master Transformation Plan for Portland Public Schools

Diagnosis · operating model · student outcomes · budget discipline · school portfolio · workforce · capital ·
implementation

Prepared for Portland Civic Lab
Evidence cutoff: August 29, 2026

Independent working plan for review — not PPS-adopted policy, not a financial audit, and not a claim of confidential access.

How to read this master plan

This document merges the Portland Civic Lab budget examination, the earlier PPS 2031 research plan, the “Movable Dollar” decision framework, PPS’s current public records, and outside education research. Where earlier drafts conflict with current primary sources, this version resolves the conflict explicitly rather than silently inheriting the old claim.

Three corrections that materially change the earlier drafts

1) PPS already publishes quarterly and later-period financial reports; the problem is forecast quality, position control, and decision follow-through, not the absence of interim reporting. 2) Comparable broad October enrollment fell from 49,478 in 2019-20 to 43,479 in 2025-26, a 12.1% observed decline; larger figures often mix forecasts or different denominators. 3) The current PAT agreement remains in effect through June 30, 2027, with a 2% salary increase effective January 1, 2027; the earlier “expired June 2026” premise is superseded by the May 2026 agreement. [F1-F5; D1; L1-L2]

Evidence language follows four labels: **Verified:** supported by a primary district/state record or high-quality research source. **Reported:** credible secondary reporting, with the source identified. **Proposed:** a Portland Civic Lab policy recommendation or target. **Illustrative:** a scenario input used to show economics; not a PPS forecast, quote, or certified saving.

The master standard is deliberately demanding: no dollar is called a saving until the cost actually ceases; no position is called a service until a student can receive it; no program is called effective merely because it exists; no school closure is called beneficial merely because seats are empty; and no external research effect is treated as a guaranteed PPS outcome.

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1. Executive decision: the PPS problem in one sentence

The master diagnosis

PPS is not primarily suffering from a lack of priorities. It is suffering from a weak connection between student need, the service promised, the position funded, the person actually available, the schedule that delivers the service, the recurring money that sustains it, and the evidence that it worked.

PPS already has an instructional framework and a 2025-2028 Continuous Improvement Plan focused on attendance, literacy, mathematics, and ninth-grade success. It already has a finance division, data team, internal performance auditor, bond oversight, multilingual and special-education systems, enrollment staff, and extensive public reporting. [D3-D6; F1; A1; C1] The highest-leverage move is therefore not to layer another strategic plan on top of these structures. It is to make the structures behave as one operating system.

The plan rests on six propositions:

1. Everyday instruction is the only intervention with enough reach to move districtwide academic outcomes materially; tutoring and other targeted supports should be concentrated where they add the most learning.
2. Attendance is instructional access. PPS cannot improve students it routinely does not reach, but attendance work must solve barriers rather than criminalize families.
3. Financial stability is an educational strategy. Midyear staffing or service disruption destroys implementation quality even when the original academic design was sound.
4. Rightsizing is necessary portfolio hygiene in a shrinking district, but a closure is not itself an educational intervention. The receiving school must be demonstrably better and the net economics must be real.
5. PPS should distinguish structural external constraints — state formula, Measure 5/50 compression, PERS, demographics — from controllable district choices, while pursuing a serious external agenda rather than using Salem as an alibi.
6. Equity belongs inside every allocation, transition, service-delivery, and outcome measure; it is not a separate program to be invoked only when decisions are already made.

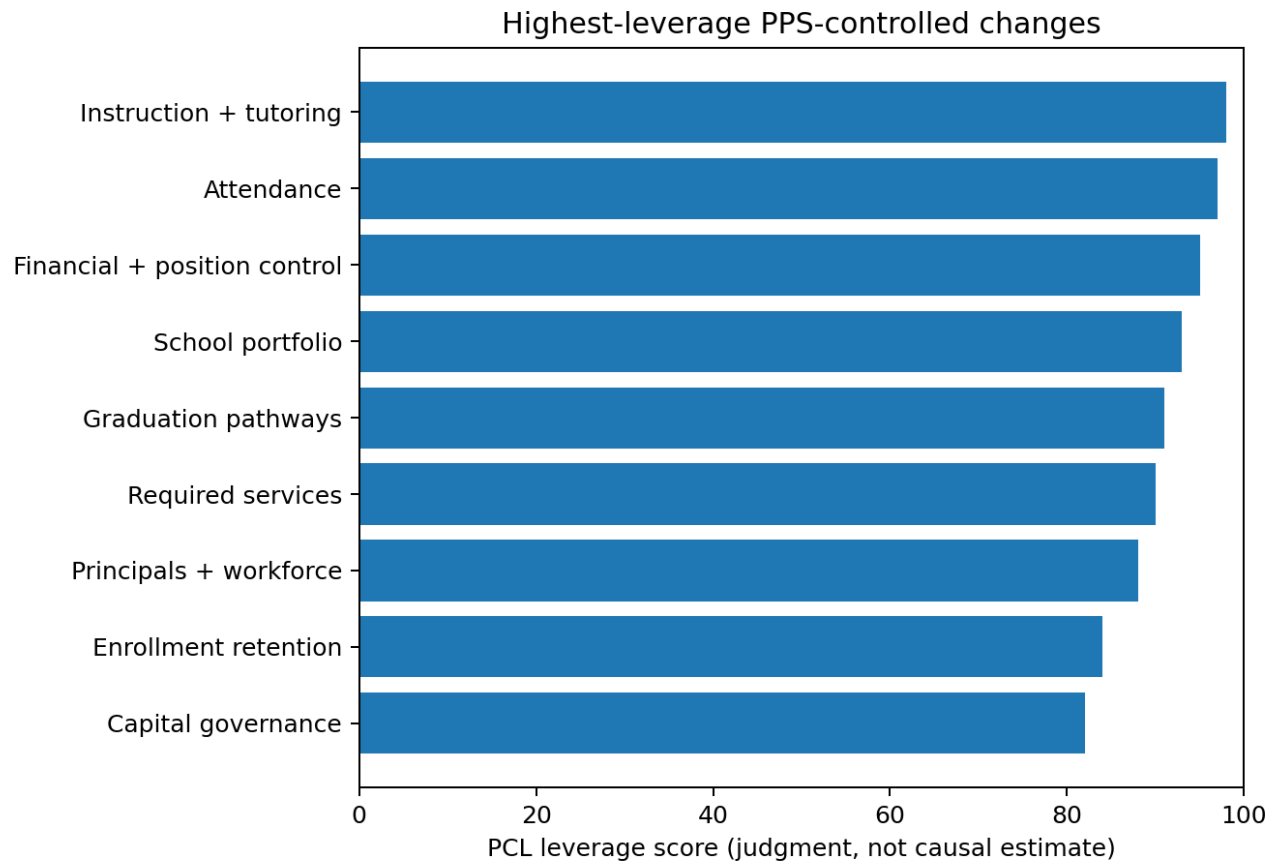


Figure 1. PCL leverage ranking. Scores are judgments about reach, evidence, feasibility, and institutional leverage; they are not causal effect estimates.

Rank	PPS-controlled change	Leverage	What success looks like
1	Everyday instruction + targeted teaching	98/100	Common high-quality instruction; rapid diagnosis; high-dosage support for students with specific unmet needs.
2	Attendance + barrier resolution	97/100	More instructional days actually received; severe absence falls; transportation/safety failures have owners.
3	Recurring budget + position control	95/100	No discretionary service is promised without recurring funding; position, payroll and coverage reconcile monthly.
4	School portfolio / rightsizing	93/100	Fewer underpowered schools only where receiving schools are stronger and ten-year net economics are positive.
5	Graduation pathways	91/100	Ninth-grade failure declines; late entrants get immediate credit plans; flexible rigorous pathways expand.
6	Required services	90/100	Multilingual and disability

Rank	PPS-controlled change	Leverage	What success looks like
			services are scheduled, delivered, monitored, and remedied when missed.
7	Principals + workforce stability	88/100	Strong leadership pipeline; coherent teacher support; fewer disruptive vacancies and midyear changes.
8	Enrollment retention	84/100	Capture and retention improve above the forecast baseline because the school experience improves.
9	Capital governance	82/100	Validated estimates govern ballot/program targets; remaining scope is transparent; lifecycle costs enter decisions.

2. The state of PPS: what is actually true now

2.1 Ten numbers that should anchor every argument

Measure	Current / recent value	What it means
All-funds adopted budget, FY2026-27	\$2.769B	Headline includes restricted capital and debt; it is not classroom operating money.
General Fund, FY2026-27	\$862.1M	The central operating ledger.
Salaries + benefits share of General Fund	78.9%	Labor and benefits dominate the cost structure; large recurring balance cannot be achieved through office supplies.
Projected FY2027-28 gap	More than \$65M	A planning floor, not a proven waste total.
Broad October enrollment	49,478 (2019-20) → 43,479 (2025-26)	Comparable observed decline of 12.1%.
Reading proficiency	56.4%	Above Oregon statewide 43.0%, but far from universal mastery.
Math proficiency	48.0%	Above Oregon statewide 31.2%; still fewer than half at proficiency.
Four-year graduation	82.5%	District average hides materially weaker subgroup outcomes.
Regular attendance	65.4% preliminary 2025-26; 67.8% appears on another public summary	Baseline definitions/periods must be reconciled before governance targets are scored.
Current PAT agreement	Through June 30, 2027; 2% increase Jan. 1, 2027	Major changes to mandatory bargaining subjects require lawful bargaining; the “expired June 2026” premise is obsolete.

Sources: U1; F7; D1; D3; N1; L1-L2. “More than \$65M” is the district’s projection and should not be converted into a precise cut target without an updated forecast.

2.2 PPS is neither a disaster nor a success story

The evidence rejects both caricatures. PPS currently outperforms Oregon averages in reading and mathematics, and its recent academic trajectory is positive. [D3] That matters: a transformation plan should preserve improvements that are working rather than reflexively replace curriculum, professional learning, or every central function. But district averages are not adequate. Reading proficiency of 56.4% means a large minority is not meeting the standard; math proficiency is 48.0%; graduation is 82.5%; and attendance remains a deep constraint. The correct posture is “protect what is working, identify where delivery fails, and intensify support where students are not succeeding.”

The fiscal story is similarly two-sided. The all-funds budget is historically large because capital projects are large, while the General Fund has tightened. Your budget examination correctly insists on separating locked, committed, movable, and unknown dollars. That distinction remains foundational.

2.3 Forecast volatility reveals an operating-control problem

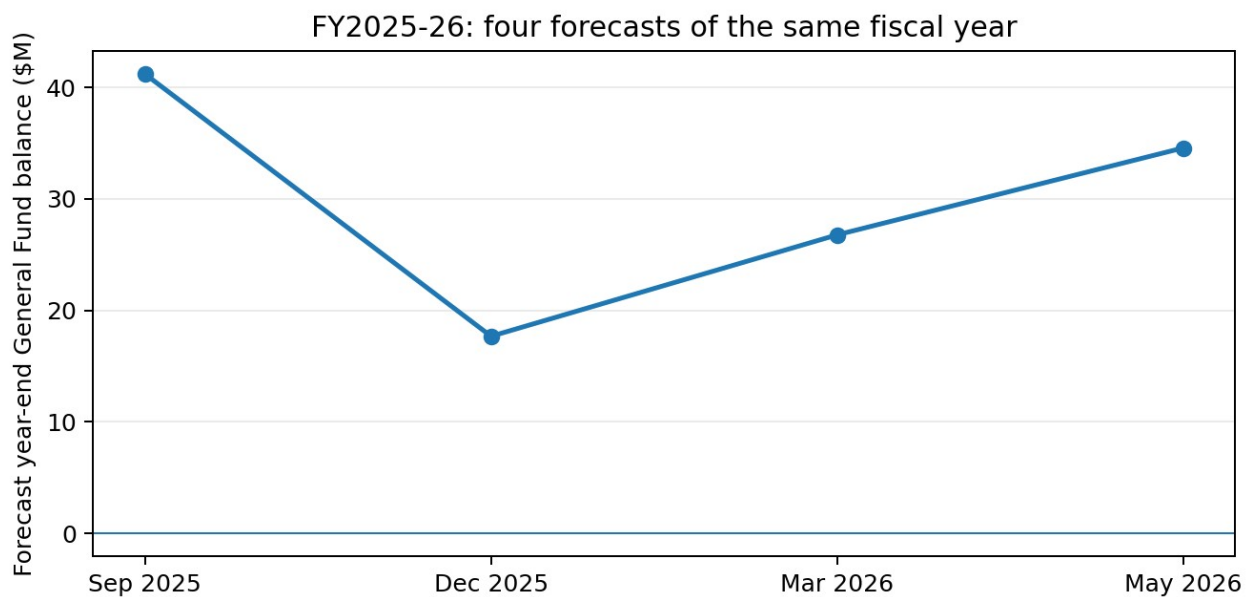


Figure 2. Successive PPS forecasts for FY2025-26. These are forecasts of the same fiscal year, not audited actuals or four different balances. [F2-F5]

The forecast ending General Fund balance moved from roughly \$41.2M after September, to \$17.7M after December, back to \$26.8M after March, and roughly \$34.6M after May. The December report identified roughly \$10M associated with staffing additions and unrealized vacancy savings among multiple drivers. [F2-F5] The lesson is not “PPS hid \$17M” or “PPS found \$17M.” The lesson is that position assumptions, staffing decisions, and forecast updating need tighter governance and clearer public explanation.

2.4 Demographics are structural, but definitions matter

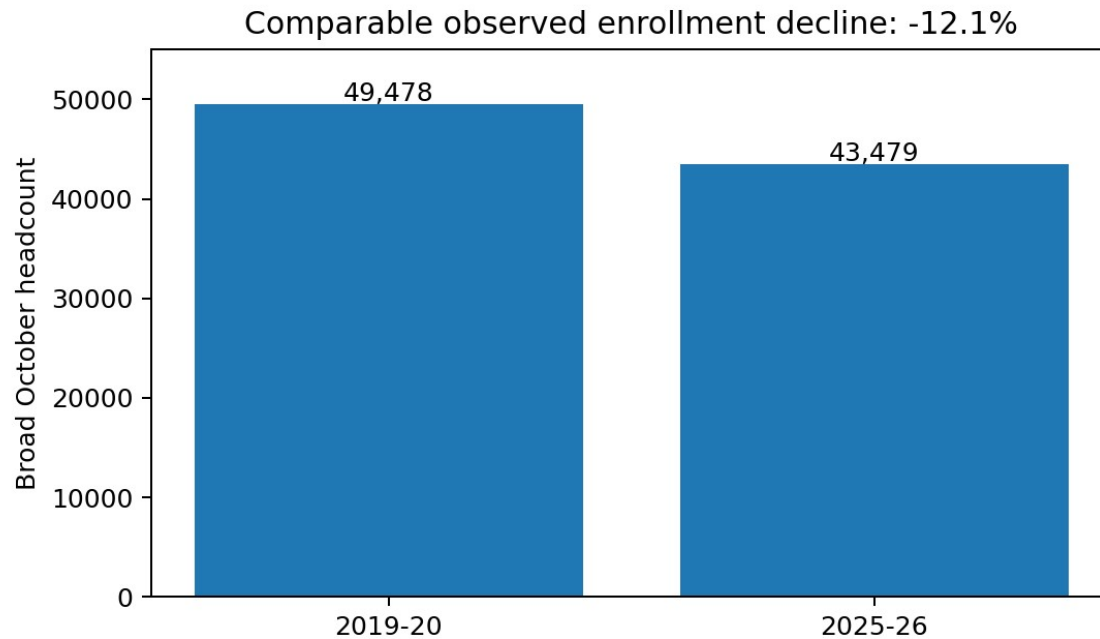


Figure 3. Comparable observed broad October headcount. Funding ADMw, PSU K-12 forecasts, and broad district enrollment are different series and should not be mixed. [D1]

PPS is a fixed-cost institution facing variable student revenue. Buildings, principals, core operations and routes do not shrink automatically when enrollment does. That geometry creates pressure even when individual programs are efficient. But the plan should use grade-by-grade and geography-specific cohorts, not a single district decline percentage, to decide staffing and school configurations.

3. What PPS controls — and what it does not

Decision / pressure	PPS control	Requires bargaining?	External dependency	Master-plan treatment
Curriculum implementation, tutoring design, assessment use	High	Sometimes impacts workload	ODE standards / grants	Act now; evaluate delivery and effect.
Attendance goals, case management, transportation response	High	Calendar changes yes	Family health/housing; County partners	Act now on supports; bargain calendar.
Position authorization, budgeting, contracts	High	Staffing impacts may require bargaining	State revenues	Act now.
School closures, boundaries, programs	High	Transition effects	Community process / transportation	Use approval gates; no quota.
Teacher compensation, workload, calendar	Shared	Yes	Labor law / contracts	Model full-year cost; negotiate.
Special-ed service delivery	High duty, constrained resources	Some staffing terms	IDEA, ODE funding, Medicaid	Meet entitlements; improve operations; advocate funding.
State School Fund formula	Low	No	Legislature / ODE	External coalition agenda.

Decision / pressure	PPS control	Requires bargaining?	External dependency	Master-plan treatment
Measure 5/50 compression	Low	No	Oregon Constitution / Legislature / voters	Statewide constitutional + statutory strategy.
PERS rates	Low	No	PERS / Legislature	Scenario-plan; advocate relief/funding.
Birth rate / household migration	None directly	No	Regional demographics/housing	Do not pretend marketing solves it; compete for eligible families.

Accountability rule

Hold PPS accountable for the quality of its response to an external constraint, not for making the constraint disappear. Conversely, do not let a state-level constraint become an excuse for district-controlled errors in staffing, procurement, scheduling, service delivery, or forecasting.

4. The operating doctrine: a funded promise to every student

The budget draft introduced the “movable dollar”: count every dollar in the open, know which dollars can move, and require movable dollars to prove their student value. The master plan extends that doctrine from money to service delivery.

The funded-promise chain

STUDENT NEED → PROMISED SERVICE → FUNDED POSITION / CONTRACT → ACTUAL STAFFING → SCHOOL SCHEDULE → DELIVERED SERVICE → STUDENT RESULT → CONTINUE / REPAIR / STOP

A district can fail at any link. A budgeted interventionist who is vacant is not a delivered intervention. A filled position constantly covering other duties is not the promised service. A delivered service with no evidence of learning is not automatically effective. A strong intervention that disappears when a grant ends is not structurally sustainable. The operating system must make those distinctions visible without asking teachers to maintain a second bureaucracy.

4.1 Five board-level guardrails

7. No recurring discretionary commitment without a recurring funding source and full-year cost.
8. No school-portfolio decision without a costed receiving-school offer, a transition budget, access analysis, and ten-year net economics.
9. No major discretionary program expansion without evidence of delivery, effect, full cost, and an explicit comparison with the current service.
10. No material financial forecast miss without a public reconciliation and a named management response.
11. No aggregate success claim without subgroup and school-level context sufficient to detect who did not benefit.

4.2 Board versus superintendent

PPS has adopted Student Outcomes Focused Governance materials emphasizing goals, constraints, monitoring, and superintendent/board role clarity. [G1] The master plan therefore keeps the board at the correct altitude: it sets outcomes, guardrails, budget standards, transparency expectations, capital rules, and approval gates. The superintendent owns operations, staffing deployment, instructional routines, case management, and execution. Board members should not become seven shadow superintendents; nor should “operational matter” become a shield against fiscal or outcome accountability.

5. Master goals and scorecard through 2031

PPS’s adopted DCIP already focuses on attendance, literacy, mathematics, and ninth-grade success. [D4] The master scorecard should preserve those goals, tighten definitions, add graduation and service-delivery measures, and make financial stability a guardrail rather than a competing mission.

Outcome	Baseline / current signal	2028-29 checkpoint	2030-31 master goal	Guardrail
Reading proficiency	56.4% (2024-25)	≥62%	≥67%	Track grade-level growth, participation, and lowest-achieving students.
Math proficiency	48.0% (2024-25)	≥55%	≥60%	Track middle-grade math and growth, not proficiency only.
Regular attendance	65.4% preliminary 2025-26; reconcile with 67.8% page	Meet or exceed adopted DCIP trajectory	≥80% if same definition remains valid	Report days missed per 100 days and severe absence; no recoding games.
Four-year graduation	82.5%	≥87%	≥90%	Keep five-year rate separate; protect mastery and transparent transfer accounting.
Historically underserved racial grouping graduation	70.3%	≥77%	≥82%	Continue individual-group reporting; do not let aggregate improvement hide gaps.
Students experiencing homelessness graduation	46.9% in cited cohort	≥57%	≥67%	Small cohorts: report uncertainty, mobility, and five-year outcomes.
Special-education graduation	71.8%	≥78%	≥84%	No reduction through under-identification or withheld services.
Required service delivery	Baseline to certify	≥98% scheduled / delivered with timely remedy	100% entitlement target with documented exceptions/remedies	Privacy-protected audit trail; distinguish paperwork compliance from instruction.
Recurring budget	>\$65M FY2027-28 projected gap	Balanced recurring plan + reserve recovery path	Recurring balance through cycle	No reserve draw, capital underspend, or speculative enrollment counted as recurring savings.

These 2029/2031 figures are proposed governance targets, not causal forecasts. Attendance should first be reconciled to one certified baseline and one definition; the existing DCIP’s adopted attendance target should not be quietly weakened merely because the starting point is difficult. [D4; N1]

6. Priority 1 — everyday instruction and targeted additional teaching

6.1 Why this ranks first

Only core classroom instruction touches essentially every student every school day. Tutoring, coaching, summer programs, AI tools, and targeted interventions can be powerful, but their coverage is narrower. If PPS

wants districtwide gains of 8-12 percentage points over several years, most of the improvement must come from stronger ordinary teaching and better instructional continuity, with targeted support accelerating students who remain behind.

6.2 Do not begin with another curriculum reset

PPS reports improved reading and mathematics results while using its current instructional framework, aligned materials, and professional learning. [D3; D5] A wholesale reset would consume implementation capacity, create transition costs, and destroy the ability to learn which parts of the current system are improving outcomes. The first task is fidelity and diagnosis: do teachers have the materials, preparation time, useful training, coaching tied to student work, and a schedule that actually permits the intended intervention?

- Use existing grade/team meetings for short instructional cycles: identify a concept students missed, inspect work, change the teaching response, then re-check.
- In early literacy, distinguish decoding, fluency, vocabulary and comprehension rather than treating “below benchmark” as one diagnosis.
- In mathematics, distinguish conceptual gaps, language access, prerequisite knowledge and insufficient practice.
- Keep grade-level content available while providing intervention; remediation that permanently removes students from core instruction can deepen the gap.
- Protect science, history, arts, physical education, career pathways, advanced learning and student engagement. A higher test score achieved by narrowing the educational mission is not the complete objective.

6.3 A bounded high-impact tutoring phase

Design choice	Proposed phase-one specification	Why
Students	~2,000 with clearly identified unmet academic need	Large enough to test at scale; small enough to protect quality.
Dosage	3 × 35 minutes/week for 30 weeks	52.5 scheduled hours/student; preserves intensity.
Group size	Ordinarily ≤3 students	Research generally finds stronger effects at smaller ratios.
Delivery standard	≥85% of planned sessions delivered	Separates theory failure from scheduling/staffing failure.
Gross planning envelope	\$5M (~\$2,500/student)	Illustrative; subtract existing eligible provision before adding new money.
Evaluation	Intent-to-treat + dosage + subject growth + subgroup results + full cost	Do not evaluate only “completers,” which selects the easiest students.

The large-scale tutoring meta-analysis used in the prior research finds scale-relevant effects materially smaller than the most famous small pilots, with a preferred estimate around 0.16 SD for programs serving at least 1,000 students. [R1] The master planning range is therefore approximately 0.10-0.20 SD among students offered a well-delivered program — meaningful, but not a guaranteed PPS result. If only 10% of a tested population receives a 0.15 SD intervention, its mechanical district-average contribution is about 0.015 SD. This is why tutoring cannot substitute for improving classroom instruction.

6.4 Coaching, assessments, and AI

- Coach against observed instructional problems. Research supports coaching, but scale weakens effects; a coaching title is not evidence of value. [R2]

- Inventory assessments and software by the distinct decision each enables, total cost, actual use, and replacement consequence. A free state test and a norm-referenced diagnostic may answer different questions.
- Use AI first for bounded, adult-reviewed work that reduces low-value workload or helps adapt approved materials. Measure time saved and error rates.
- Do not automate high-stakes discipline, disability eligibility, final grades, or school-closure decisions. Software adoption is an input, not a student outcome.

7. Priority 2 — attendance, safety, belonging, and instructional access

PPS's DCIP makes attendance one of four district priorities and calls for a 15% increase in overall good attendance and a 24% increase for focal groups. [D4] Preliminary 2025-26 reporting showed regular attendance rising from roughly 64% to 65.4%, still short of the district's intended trajectory. [N1] Rather than replace the goal, the master plan makes the operating response more precise.

7.1 Attendance is a barrier-resolution system

12. Each school has one named attendance-response owner inside the existing leadership/student-support structure.
13. Use a proposed early warning such as three absences in 20 school days to trigger review — not punishment.
14. Contact families quickly, in their preferred language, and classify the primary barrier: illness, transportation, housing instability, bullying/safety, school avoidance, academic frustration, caregiving/work, family logistics, or unknown.
15. Assign a responsible office to the barrier. A late bus is an operations issue; harassment is a safety issue; academic avoidance is an instructional issue; housing instability requires partner coordination.
16. Follow the case to resolution or documented escalation. "Referral made" is not the outcome.

A major IES experiment found adaptive family messaging can reduce absenteeism but did not detect an academic achievement effect after one year. [R3] Messaging is therefore the cheap first layer, not the solution. The high-value work is accurate barrier diagnosis plus the institutional ability to solve the barrier.

7.2 Anti-gaming and safeguards

- Publish regular-attender rates and days missed per 100 enrolled days; the threshold alone hides severity.
- Audit attendance coding on a sample of schools each year.
- Never use attendance as an automatic school-closure criterion; that creates incentives and disproportionately penalizes schools serving students with greater external barriers.
- Do not encourage infectious attendance or penalize medically appropriate absence.
- Disaggregate by school and major student groups, while protecting small-cell privacy.

7.3 Calendar coherence belongs at the bargaining table

The CBRC has highlighted calendar fragmentation, but planning, professional development, conferences, grading and workday structure are not free variables. The current PAT agreement extends through June 30, 2027. [L1-L2] PPS should cost calendar alternatives and make coherence a future bargaining objective if the evidence supports it, rather than pretend the board can unilaterally rearrange mandatory working conditions. Transportation reliability can and should be treated as an attendance intervention immediately.

8. Priority 3 — recurring budgets, position control, and decision-quality

This is the highest-leverage enabling reform. The district can have an excellent instructional strategy and still fail students if it discovers in February that staffing assumptions were wrong and must remove service midyear. The master objective is not “zero surprises”; that can be achieved by sandbagging. The objective is forecast accuracy, explicit uncertainty, and timely corrective action.

8.1 Preserve and improve the interim reporting PPS already has

Earlier drafts incorrectly treated interim reporting as absent. PPS currently publishes quarterly financial reports and later monthly/period reports. [F1] Preserve that capacity. Improve the reports with prior-year seasonal comparators, a revision log, a forecast-accuracy scorecard, and public reconciliation of material changes. The correct reform is better decision information, not performative publication volume.

8.2 One reconciled position ledger

Field that must reconcile	Why it matters
Position ID + authorization	Prevents “positions” from appearing outside the budgeted establishment.
School / department + role	Connects cost to the service expected.
Fund + grant expiration	Shows whether a service survives the funding source.
Salary schedule + step + benefits + full-year cost	Prevents part-year figures from being mistaken for recurring cost.
Incumbent / vacancy / start date	Makes vacancy-savings assumptions testable.
Actual service coverage	A vacant interventionist and a filled interventionist are not equivalent student experiences.
Exception authority	Required or emergency supports can proceed, but funding consequences cannot be invisible.

Finance and HR should certify the position ledger together. Program leaders certify the service obligation. A discretionary addition should not be financed by a generic assumption that “vacancies elsewhere” will pay for it.

8.3 Three-year recurring bridge

- Start with audited/closed prior-year results, not the adopted budget.
- Separate recurring revenue from beginning fund balance, one-time grants, transfers, bond money, and financing.
- Model enrollment, salary schedules, steps, benefits, the January 2027 PAT increase, PERS rates/credits, debt-service interactions, grant expirations, and special-education reimbursements with dated assumptions.
- Publish baseline, downside and upside cases; attach an owner to each assumption.
- Any recurring program funded by temporary money must show the cliff and the planned exit, shrinkage, or replacement source on the same page as the program.

8.4 Savings certification — no efficiency plug

Candidate category	Initial treatment	What counts as a real saving
Contracts / licenses	Review first	Cash that actually stops, net of termination and replacement cost, from

Candidate category	Initial treatment	What counts as a real saving
		the correct fund.
Central workflows / staffing	Benchmark + redesign	A removed recurring cost with a stated service consequence and no duplicate count elsewhere.
School scheduling / allocation	Grade-by-grade model	Whole-section or support changes with educational effects stated.
School portfolio	Separate gate	Net of receiving-school, transport, residual-property, transition and enrollment-response costs.
Enrollment improvement	Zero budget credit until certified	Net marginal funding after timing, formula and added variable costs.
Reserve draw	Never a saving	Financing only.
Capital underspend	Never operating saving	Restricted capital capacity, not teacher payroll.

The prior “Movable Dollar” red-team version correctly withdrew a speculative \$26M redirect and replaced it with a much smaller first-pass candidate range for verified General Fund savings. The master document goes one step further: it enters ****zero certified savings**** until line-by-line evidence exists. A working target may guide the review; it does not balance the budget.

8.5 Citizen oversight

The CBRC has repeatedly argued that the review window is inadequate. PPS itself now acknowledges room for improvement and plans more continuous CBRC engagement. [F8; F9] The solution is staged access: assumptions in winter, function/object detail as modules are ready, proposed budget on the statutory calendar, and written PPS responses to material CBRC recommendations before adoption. This is more useful than simply moving the final book earlier when state revenue information is still changing.

9. Priority 4 — the school portfolio: rightsizing into better schools

As of late August 2026, no final closure list has been adopted. Superintendent Armstrong has publicly said the eventual number could be roughly 10 to 20, while current modeling explores configurations such as bringing remaining elementary schools above a 360-student threshold. [P1-P3] These are scenarios, not proof that a particular closure count is optimal. The master plan refuses a quota.

The rightsizing rule

Close or consolidate a school only when the receiving-school experience is credibly better or at least protected, the net ten-year economics are positive under conservative assumptions, access remains acceptable, required services are ready, and the transition can be executed without avoidable educational damage.

9.1 Six approval gates

Gate	Required evidence before vote
Educational offer	Funded staffing and schedule for core instruction, intervention, special education, language pathways, arts/PE/library, counseling, advanced learning, climate/safety.
Usable capacity	Actual rooms after specialized programs, accessibility, construction, circulation and scheduling — not gross square

Gate	Required evidence before vote
	footage divided by a nominal class size.
Access	Walk routes, travel times, bus capacity/reliability, after-school access and individualized transport.
Net economics	Avoidable site costs minus receiving resources, transportation, residual site costs, transition costs, enrollment response and timing.
Equity + history	Historic underinvestment and past closure burdens explicitly tested; no single cluster bears disproportionate disruption without a compelling reason.
Readiness	Named receiving leadership, staff, student placements, curriculum continuity, support-service readiness, building readiness, funded transition.

9.2 Why building utilization alone is inadequate

An underused building can still contain full classrooms because grade cohorts are uneven and staffing changes in whole sections. A 250-student school may be inefficient, but a 360-student threshold is not a law of educational quality. PPS should model each feasible cluster and program pathway. The output should be a portfolio frontier: combinations that satisfy educational/access constraints, ranked by ten-year net cost and transition risk.

9.3 Closure economics

Illustrative single-school economics	Annual / one-time
Avoidable site staffing + operations	\$1.20M / year
Additional receiving-school resources	-\$0.35M / year
Additional transportation	-\$0.20M / year
Residual closed-site carrying cost	-\$0.10M / year
Illustrative net contribution lost from additional family departures	-\$0.15M / year
Illustrative net recurring saving	\$0.40M / year
Illustrative one-time transition cost	\$1.20M
Simple steady-state payback	3 years

This table is deliberately hypothetical. It demonstrates why “school budget” is not “closure saving.” Teachers and students moving to the receiving school may move together; transportation can rise; buildings still need security and maintenance; and transition has a cash cost. Actual combinations could save more, less, or even lose money.

9.4 Timing and trust

- Publish criteria before the list, and publish feasible alternatives with enough time for independent scrutiny.
- Give affected communities the receiving-school program, transportation analysis, transition plan and likely building-use path before the final decision.
- Assign receiving-school leadership early and conduct a readiness gate before the move.
- Stage moves when implementation capacity is the binding constraint. A rushed closure that drives enrollment loss or program failure can destroy its own economics.

- Do not promise that closures alone solve a >\$65M structural gap. They correct geometry and can release resources, but they are not the entire fiscal strategy.

10. Priority 5 — graduation pathways: ninth grade and late entrants

PPS is right to focus on ninth-grade on-track status. Research from Chicago and randomized early-warning work shows that absence and course failure in ninth grade are powerful early signals and can be improved with structured monitoring. [R4; R9] But PPS-specific cohort data adds a crucial insight: students first enrolling in PPS after ninth grade had a reported four-year graduation rate of roughly 53.2% in the cited cohort. [D2] A freshman-only strategy therefore leaves a major failure point untreated.

10.1 Weekly on-track operating routine

- Review attendance, course failure, credits and schedule anomalies weekly through existing high-school teams.
- Newly off-track students receive a barrier review and named responsible adult within five school days.
- Intervention can include tutoring, schedule repair, attendance support, mental-health or safety response, credit planning, or a more relevant pathway.
- Report recovery rate: how many newly off-track students return on track within the term.

10.2 Late-entry guarantee

Ten-school-day guarantee

Every student first entering PPS after ninth grade receives a transcript/credit review, appropriate recognition of prior learning, language/disability screening and supports, a realistic completion sequence, and a named adviser within ten school days.

CTE, dual credit, arts, internships, work-based learning and applied projects should make rigorous learning feel connected to a student's future. High graduation among program participants should not be presented as causal proof without accounting for selection; access, completion and outcomes should all be monitored.

11. Priority 6 — multilingual, special-education, and required services

The February 2026 internal Multilingual Learners / English Language Development audit is one of the strongest windows into PPS's institutional mechanics. It tested compliance processes, identified weaknesses, and made nine recommendations accepted by management; the public audit index lists status-of-implementation work expected in fall 2026. [A1; A2] The useful lesson is not that staff do not care. It is that monitoring without authority to secure school-level completion produces overdue obligations.

11.1 Required-service control loop

17. For every legal/IEP/ELD service, reconcile requirement → scheduled service → actual delivery.
18. Flag missed or overdue service automatically and assign an owner with authority to resolve it.
19. Remedy missed obligations appropriately; do not treat a completed form or training as proof the service reached the child.
20. Review vacancies, caseloads, outside placements, therapies, transportation and contracted services by workload and student need, not by crude cost ranking.

21. Independent audit follow-up tests whether corrective controls operate, not merely whether management wrote a procedure.

11.2 Special-education funding — avoid the 11% arithmetic trap

Oregon’s special-education weighting includes an 11% cap but also a waiver process and other funding mechanisms. [S1] Therefore “PPS serves ~17%; state funds only 11%; the difference equals the unfunded cost” is not a valid calculation. PPS should publish the actual waiver, high-cost reimbursements, federal/state support, service cost, and General Fund contribution. The district should never set a “savings” target that can be met by under-identifying students or withholding entitled services.

11.3 Protect evidence-backed language pathways

PPS has unusually relevant local lottery-based evidence on dual-language immersion showing English-reading benefits in the studied context without detected math/science disadvantage. [R6] Rightsizing should therefore preserve coherent program pathways and access for partner-language speakers unless a program-specific analysis demonstrates a better alternative. Immersion does not replace appropriate English-language development, newcomer support, or individualized disability services.

12. Priority 7 — principals, teachers, workforce stability, and labor

12.1 Principals are the implementation layer

A principal translates district policy into schedule, staffing, climate, teacher support, intervention quality, family trust and daily execution. Principal-pipeline research supports deliberate preparation, development and placement. [R5] PPS should use its strongest leaders to mentor emerging principals, establish succession plans for critical schools, and protect leadership continuity at receiving schools during rightsizing.

- Judge leadership using student growth, attendance improvement, staff continuity, climate, family experience, required-service reliability and operational execution — not affluent-school proficiency alone.
- Give principals clear decision rights and an escalation path for problems central departments must solve.
- Do not combine a closure/boundary change, new principal, major curriculum shift, and multiple new systems at the same receiving school unless unavoidable.

12.2 Teacher compact

PPS should offer educators coherent materials, useful professional learning, preparation time, safe classrooms, predictable staffing, credible discipline/safety support, and intervention capacity. In return, the district can reasonably expect participation in collaborative instructional improvement and agreed service-delivery routines. Every new reporting requirement should eliminate or combine low-value work elsewhere; transformation cannot simply be additional paperwork.

12.3 Labor status and bargaining map

The official PPS PAT page states the 2023-26 agreement is in effect through June 30, 2027, with a 2% salary increase effective January 1, 2027; the Board approved a 2026-27 agreement on May 26, 2026. [L1-L2] This supersedes the earlier draft’s assertion that the contract expired June 30, 2026.

Plan element	Primary vehicle now
Financial reporting, budget assumptions, CBRC access	Board policy / superintendent implementation.
Position control and affordability certification	Management, consistent with contracts and law.
Attendance goals/reporting/barrier resolution	Board goals + management; specific staffing impacts may be bargained.

Plan element	Primary vehicle now
Calendar coherence	Bargaining-sensitive; model and negotiate rather than impose.
Teacher workload / compensation / bargaining-unit staffing	Collective bargaining / contract processes.
School closure transition effects	Board authority over portfolio, with labor effects handled through contract and bargaining obligations.
Contract/vendor changes	Management/procurement authority, with labor impacts handled lawfully.

Before any new labor commitment, publish full-year salary, step, benefit and staffing scenarios with the service consequences of each option. “Fair compensation” and “affordable staffing level” are two legitimate constraints that must be solved simultaneously.

13. Priority 8 — enrollment retention and family experience

Enrollment improvement is strategically valuable but fiscally slow. In a declining district where state funding can use prior-year enrollment, recovering one marginal student may add little immediate funding until the recovery exceeds the underlying decline. The older PSU forecast reviewed in the prior research already built in partial kindergarten capture recovery. [D7] The district must therefore measure improvement ****above the current budget forecast****, not above a stale current rate, or it will double-count revenue.

13.1 The enrollment system PPS should run

- Use the existing enrollment function rather than build a new bureaucracy.
- Publish a versioned kindergarten capture methodology and denominator, produced or independently validated by the research/data function.
- Track inquiry → assignment → enrollment → first 30 days → first-year retention → next-year retention.
- Offer brief, translated exit surveys to departing families; publish response rates and de-identified reason distributions.
- Distinguish families who moved from those who remained resident and chose another option.
- Route exit reasons into operations: safety complaints to safety, special-ed service failures to Student Support, schedule/program demand to academic planning.

13.2 Illustrative long-run economics

If an eligible entering cohort were 4,000 children, PPS improved capture by three percentage points ****above the forecast baseline****, and 95% of those incremental students were retained each year, the illustrative gain would be about 120 new students in each cohort and roughly 543 retained students across five accumulated cohorts. At an illustrative \$6,000 net annual contribution per retained student after marginal costs, year-five annualized contribution would be about \$3.26M before state funding timing. Every input here is illustrative and should carry zero budget credit until the latest forecast and marginal funding/cost model certify it.

14. Priority 9 — capital governance and the 2025 bond

The capital problem is not that PPS lacks independent estimates or audits. In multiple bond cycles, independent cost information existed; the consequential question is how leadership and the board converted estimates into ballot/program targets and how scope changes were reconciled. The master standard therefore targets decision discipline, not another oversight layer.

14.1 The capital-honesty rule

No unsupported target

No ballot or program figure should be set below the current validated estimate range unless the public board record reconciles the difference line by line: scope removed, escalation changed, contingency changed, phasing changed, or another financing assumption. The voter-facing description should disclose the reconciliation.

- Rebaseline the 2025 program against current scope and validated estimates; distinguish original ballot commitments, approved revisions, current estimate-at-completion ranges, contingency and uncommitted scope.
- Publish estimate-at-completion ranges and decompose market escalation from controllable residual where practicable.
- Keep bond-audit recommendation follow-up current and visible; as of the latest public index, the Year 6 implementation update remained listed as expected in summer 2026. [C1]
- Require a ten-year operating-cost statement for major facilities: staffing, utilities, maintenance, insurance, transport and program implications.
- Do not multiply the entire bond authorization by an arbitrary “efficiency percentage.” Focus on remaining uncommitted choices.

14.2 Jefferson and Center for Black Student Excellence

Capital honesty must not become a one-way ratchet that disciplines historically underserved communities only after prior projects have already benefited from optimistic assumptions. Jefferson and the Center for Black Student Excellence require transparent scope, budget, schedule and community decisions. The principle is symmetry: the same cost discipline and disclosure standard applies everywhere, while prior commitments and historic underinvestment remain explicit decision criteria.

15. Equity as a system constraint, not a rhetorical appendix

The 2019 state audit and PPS’s own equity policy make it impossible to evaluate the district using averages alone. The master plan therefore treats equity as a measurement and decision constraint: who receives the service, who bears the disruption, who benefits from the investment, and whether a policy closes or widens existing gaps.

System decision	Equity requirement
Academic interventions	Report access, dosage and effect by school and student group; avoid concentrating the best implementation only where staffing is easiest.
Attendance	Disaggregate absence and barrier types; do not use police referral as default attendance strategy.
Rightsizing	Historic underinvestment and prior closure burden are explicit criteria; receiving schools in affected communities are funded for transition first.
Enrollment	Capture/retention tracked by geography and group so PPS cannot hit a district target by serving only easier-to-retain families.
Capital	Cost honesty applied symmetrically; prior commitments and community scope decisions are visible.
Staffing	Track vacancies, turnover and service reliability by school need; a formally equal allocation can produce unequal delivery.
Program ROI	Evaluate the equity staffing/allocation model before expanding

System decision	Equity requirement
	or cutting it; values spending should be measurable enough to defend.

Live litigation or constitutional questions around particular allocation criteria should receive legal review. The empirical obligation — measure who benefits and whether gaps close — remains valid regardless of the legal theory ultimately applied.

16. The external game: Salem, Multnomah County, and the 2029 levy

A master PPS plan that ignores state finance is incomplete. A master PPS plan that blames the state for district-controlled execution is equally incomplete. PPS should run a two-track strategy: internal operating reform and a disciplined external coalition agenda.

External ask	Why it matters	Correct venue / design
Special-education funding	High-need services create real General Fund pressure; 11% weighting is incomplete without waivers/appropriation.	Legislature / ODE: cap/weight changes paired with adequate appropriation and high-cost support.
Local-option compression	Teacher levy loses substantial voter-approved yield.	Constitutional referral for structural change plus a statutory state-backfill strategy as a nearer-term option.
PERS school-district cost pressure	Benefit-rate changes can overwhelm local operating choices.	Legislature / PERS: transparent statewide fiscal note, stabilization or state assumption options.
Adequacy / State School Fund	PPS cannot solve statewide current-service funding alone.	Coalition with districts/OSBA/education stakeholders; preserve a credible adequacy frame.
Early-childhood transition	Kindergarten capture and readiness connect to county Preschool for All.	Multnomah County IGA / data-sharing with consent and provider neutrality.
2029 local option levy	A major additive local operating stream.	Begin trust, effective-rate transparency and renewal planning in 2028; do not wait for campaign season.

17. Financial reconciliation: what pays for what

The hard rule

A plan that spends the same dollar twice is not a plan. In a deficit year, new investments require a verified offset, a new recurring source, or an explicit decision to cut something else. Savings estimates do not become appropriations merely because they are plausible.

FY2027-28 planning line	Illustrative amount	Status
District projected structural gap	>\$65M	District projection; update with current forecast.
Targeted tutoring phase	\$5M gross	Illustrative; net existing eligible provision.
Attendance barrier-resolution capacity	\$1M gross	Illustrative.

FY2027-28 planning line	Illustrative amount	Status
High-school recovery / late-entry capacity	\$1M gross	Illustrative.
Leadership/coaching capacity	\$1M gross	Illustrative; reallocate first where possible.
Gross priority envelope	\$8M	Illustrative, not automatically new spend.
Certified recurring savings	\$0 entered in this master plan	Deliberately zero until line-by-line certification.
Certified net new enrollment revenue	\$0 entered	No credit until timing/marginal costs are certified.
Transition funding	Unpriced until portfolio selected	Must be explicit one-time cash.
Reserve restoration	Unpriced until actual close and policy path	Must not be hidden.

The implication is uncomfortable but essential: if the current >\$65M gap persists, PPS cannot simultaneously fund every attractive new idea and avoid meaningful reductions. The transformation strategy is to protect high-return services, eliminate low-value/duplicative spending where verified, correct the footprint over time, negotiate workforce choices transparently, pursue external revenue, and stop generating new unfunded recurring commitments.

17.1 Recommended order of claims on verified savings

22. Restore recurring balance and protect legally required services.
23. Fund the control capacity necessary to keep the budget and service promises reliable.
24. Protect core classroom instruction and proven high-value supports.
25. Fund receiving-school transitions before counting closure savings as available.
26. Use the remainder for targeted interventions with evidence of delivery and effect.
27. Rebuild reserves on a published multiyear path.

I do ****not**** recommend a rigid permanent 60/40 or 70/30 split between deficit reduction and reinvestment. Those ratios in the earlier red-team draft were useful commitment devices, but a master policy should make the split contingent on the actual gap, reserve position, and transition requirements. The non-negotiable principle is that receiving-school obligations and required services are not financed with fictional savings.

18. Governance, accountability, and who owns each decision

Named owners below reflect the current publicly identified PPS leadership structure where available; titles can change, so the governing document should assign accountability to offices, not personalities. [G2; F1]

Workstream	Accountable office	Current public leader / anchor	Board role
District transformation	Superintendent	Dr. Kimberlee Armstrong	Set goals/guardrails; evaluate superintendent.
Finance + position control	Finance + HR	CFO Michelle Morrison + HR leadership	Budget standards, recurring balance, public monitoring.
Instruction + tutoring	Academics	Sr. Chief Academics Kristina Howard	Outcome goals, funded envelope, evaluation guardrails.
School execution / attendance	Chief of Schools	Chief of Schools office	Attendance/outcome monitoring; do not manage

Workstream	Accountable office	Current public leader / anchor	Board role
			cases.
Required services	Student Support + Multilingual	Student Support leadership; ML/ELD department	Set compliance/service guardrails.
Rightsizing / facilities / transport	Operations + Schools + Finance	Operations leadership	Approve portfolio changes only after gates.
Data / evaluation	Data & Accountability	Richard Smith and evaluation/analytics team on public page	Require independent definitions and reporting.
Capital	Bond / Operations + CFO	Existing bond program + BAC/audit structure	Capital-honesty rule, scope decisions, oversight.
External agenda	Government Relations + Superintendent	Government Relations office	Adopt legislative priorities.

The board's job

Approve goals, guardrails, budgets, labor agreements, material contracts and portfolio/capital decisions; demand transparent evidence; and replace assumptions when evidence changes. Do not select individual tutoring vendors, design principal schedules, or manage school-level attendance cases from the dais.

19. Implementation roadmap: first 90 days through 2031

19.1 First 90 days

28. Adopt the funded-promise doctrine, master scorecard, definitions rule, and anti-double-counting financial policy.
29. Reconcile the current position ledger and FY2026 close/forecast-to-actual bridge; identify every material staffing or vacancy assumption that drove forecast variance.
30. Certify one attendance baseline/definition and preserve the adopted DCIP trajectory rather than changing goals midstream.
31. Publish school-portfolio criteria and the required contents of every school-level net-cost and receiving-school analysis before any final list is approved.
32. Inventory current tutoring/intervention dosage and results before buying a new universal layer.
33. Obtain current implementation evidence for the nine Multilingual/ELD audit recommendations and establish escalation for open items.
34. Rebaseline major 2025 bond commitments into original scope, current validated estimate, approved changes, remaining contingency and uncommitted scope.
35. Establish continuous CBRC access and a written-response protocol for material recommendations.

19.2 By spring 2027

36. Publish the three-year recurring financial bridge, including full-year labor/PERS/grant assumptions.
37. Complete the benchmarked contract/central-workflow review and enter only certified recurring savings in the public savings register.
38. Complete feasible rightsizing portfolios with educational, access, equity, financial and readiness gates; fund transitions explicitly.
39. Launch the bounded tutoring phase only if current-service inventory shows unmet need and recurring/eligible funding is identified.
40. Run weekly ninth-grade on-track reviews and the ten-school-day late-entry guarantee across all high schools.

41. Adopt the next labor bargaining strategy with full-year cost and service scenarios well before the 2027 contract boundary.

19.3 2027-28 through 2031

- Execute school moves in waves sized to implementation capacity; suspend a later wave if prior receiving-school promises were not funded or delivered.
- Scale tutoring, attendance and other discretionary interventions only when delivery and effect justify it.
- Move from annual budget crisis to rolling three-year recurring balance and reserve recovery.
- Use enrollment retention as a decade strategy, not an immediate budget plug.
- Prepare the 2029 local-option levy renewal beginning in 2028 with transparent effective-rate and program reporting.
- Report the 2031 scorecard without rewriting old baselines or targets.

ID	Deadline	Action	Owner	Acceptance test
A01	30 days	Position + payroll reconciliation	Finance + HR	100% authorized positions tied to fund, cost, incumbent/vacancy and service.
A02	30 days	Outcome/baseline dictionary	Data + Schools	One versioned definition for enrollment, attendance, graduation and academic measures.
A03	45 days	ML/ELD remediation status	Student Support + Schools	Evidence of operation for each audit action, not policy text alone.
A04	60 days	Current intervention inventory	Academics + CFO	Student count, dosage, cost, funding source, outcomes, expiration.
A05	60 days	Savings register v1	CFO	Every line non-overlapping, recurring, fund-correct, with FY cash timing.
A06	60 days	Rightsizing model spec	Operations + Academics + CFO	Six gates + 10-year net model + transition cash + access analysis.
A07	90 days	Capital rebaseline	Bond program + CFO	Original vs current scope/estimate/contingency/uncommitted decisions.
A08	90 days	CBRC continuous review protocol	Board + CFO	Staged materials + written recommendation disposition.
A09	Jan 2027	Tutoring phase go/no-go	Academics + CFO	Unmet need, funding, staffing capacity and evaluation design all passed.
A10	Mar 2027	Balanced FY2027-28 choices	Superintendent + CFO	No speculative savings plug; transition/reserve needs explicit.
A11	Before portfolio move	Receiving-school readiness	Schools + Operations	Leadership, staffing, required services, transportation and facility ready.
A12	June annually	Master scorecard review	Board + Superintendent	Original targets retained; variances explained; scale/repair/stop decisions

ID	Deadline	Action	Owner	Acceptance test
				made.

20. Red-team: the strongest objections and tripwires

Objection	Best version of the critique	Master-plan response / tripwire
"This is just austerity in nicer language."	A deficit frame can rationalize cutting services communities value.	Required services and core instruction are explicit guardrails; cuts must identify service consequences; equity and receiving-school gates constrain footprint decisions.
"Closures will accelerate enrollment loss."	Displaced families may leave, destroying savings and community trust.	Model 0/5/10% attrition sensitivity; count lost net contribution; stage moves; readiness failure can defer.
"More accountability means more bureaucracy."	Teachers already spend too much time entering data.	Use existing systems and eliminate low-value reporting for each new requirement; student-level data should be captured from operations wherever possible.
"Tutoring is expensive and impossible to scale."	Large-scale effects are smaller and staffing is hard.	Start bounded; protect dosage; evaluate intent-to-treat and cost; expand only when delivery/effect pass.
"Central office is where the waste is."	Classroom cuts while administration survives are politically toxic.	Benchmark like-for-like and cut unexplained overhead, but do not destroy finance, payroll, compliance or support functions necessary to deliver student service.
"PPS just needs more money."	Oregon funding constraints are real.	Run the Salem agenda aggressively, while showing PPS-controlled execution improvements to make the revenue case credible.
"PPS has plenty of money; the \$2.77B proves it."	Headline budget is enormous.	Separate General Fund, restricted capital, debt and special revenue. Bond money cannot legally become teachers.
"Targets will be gamed."	Organizations optimize the metric.	Use denominators, days-missed severity, participation, transfer accounting, coding audits, frozen chart crosswalks, and original-target history.
"Equity criteria themselves are contested."	Legal/political challenges may constrain race-conscious allocations.	Use legal review, but preserve transparent subgroup outcomes, need measures, historic burdens and ROI analysis.
"The board will micromanage."	Detailed operational motions undermine superintendent accountability.	Board sets outcomes, guardrails, approval gates and reporting; superintendent owns execution.

20.1 Automatic tripwires

- If the recurring gap worsens materially, freeze discretionary expansion until the updated funding bridge is adopted.
- If a tutoring phase delivers <75% of planned dosage, repair delivery before interpreting academic effect; if ≥85% dosage with weak effect, redesign rather than merely scale.
- If a receiving school fails a critical safety, staffing, required-service or transportation readiness gate, defer that move unless an emergency necessity is documented.
- If closure net savings are below the validated threshold or become negative under a reasonable attrition case, do not justify the move on savings grounds.
- If forecast misses repeatedly exceed the board's materiality threshold, require a root-cause review of the assumption/position-control system.

- If an audit recommendation remains open past its date, it becomes a standing public item until independently verified closed.

21. What PPS should explicitly not do

42. Do not launch a districtwide curriculum reset while current academic results are improving without evidence the core materials are the binding problem.
43. Do not adopt a school-closure quota (“5,” “15,” or “20”) before the feasible portfolio analysis.
44. Do not promise that closures solve the structural deficit.
45. Do not claim a purchased-services percentage is all addressable General Fund waste; capital, litigation, mandated and one-time items can dominate the headline.
46. Do not slash “central office” by percentage without protecting payroll, finance controls, grants, required-service coordination and other functions whose failure causes larger downstream costs.
47. Do not treat universal class-size reduction as the default use of scarce dollars; target staffing where marginal student value is highest and respect safety/contract constraints.
48. Do not count enrollment recovery as immediate revenue or count the recovery already assumed in a forecast a second time.
49. Do not use AI as a substitute for teachers, counselors, legal eligibility decisions, or accountable adults.
50. Do not finance recurring programs from one-time balances without publishing the cliff.
51. Do not lower targets after the fact and call the lower target success.

22. The controlled data room and unresolved questions

The master strategy is actionable now, but the exact budget package and school list should not be fabricated from incomplete public aggregates. PPS should assemble a controlled decision data room. Where student-level data is needed, access should be minimum-necessary, secure, and privacy compliant.

Needed dataset / document	Decision it settles
Final FY2025-26 close + audited reconciliation	Starting reserve, recurring deficit, forecast-quality diagnosis.
Authorized position ledger + payroll extract + grants expirations	True recurring staffing affordability and vacancy assumptions.
Latest PSU / district forecast used for budget and assignment	Enrollment timing, geography, capture assumptions, downside case.
Grade-by-grade sections + usable rooms + specialized programs	Feasible school consolidations and staffing savings.
School-level fixed/avoidable costs + receiving costs	Net closure savings.
Transportation route/capacity/reliability model	Access and recurring cost after rightsizing.
Current intervention staffing/dosage/outcomes	Whether a new tutoring purchase adds anything.
SPED waivers + high-cost reimbursements + service cost + external placements	Actual General Fund pressure and operational opportunities.
Current ML/ELD audit remediation evidence	Which 2026 weaknesses remain open.
Contract universe with fund, usage, renewal/termination, owner	Verified contract savings and overlap.
2025 bond current scope/EAC/contingency/commitments	Remaining capital decision leverage.
Original Southeast rebalancing evaluation and school-level findings	Transition design and avoidable risks.
Family departure reasons + response rates	Retention strategy and closure attrition sensitivity.

23. Source register and method

Evidence cutoff: August 29, 2026. Primary district/state materials receive priority; secondary reporting is used for current context or when a primary document was not retrieved. Research studies inform intervention design but are not treated as PPS-specific causal forecasts. The user-supplied Portland Civic Lab budget draft is a major factual synthesis, but where its claims conflicted with current primary sources, this master document uses the current primary source and records the correction.

ID	Source	Use / limitation
U1	Portland Civic Lab, “Where the Next Dollar Goes,” September 2026 working draft	User-supplied working paper; budget/fund/enrollment/bond synthesis; judgments distinguished from source facts.
U2	Portland Civic Lab, “The Movable Dollar Plan,” September 2026 working draft	User-supplied decision framework; red-team ideas retained where evidence supports them; labor-status premise corrected.
F1	PPS Finance — Period Financial Reports	https://www.pps.net/departments/finance/finance — interim reporting exists, including Q1-Q3 and later monthly periods.
F2	PPS FY2025-26 Q1 financial report	PPS resource-manager report; Sept. 30, 2025 forecast.
F3	PPS FY2025-26 Q2 financial report	PPS resource-manager report; Dec. 31, 2025 forecast; staffing/vacancy discussion.
F4	PPS FY2025-26 Q3 financial report	PPS resource-manager report; Mar. 31, 2026 forecast.
F5	PPS FY2025-26 May / Period 11 report	PPS resource-manager report; May 31, 2026 forecast.
F6	PPS Annual Comprehensive Financial Reports / FY2025 findings	https://www.pps.net/board/board-of-education/pps-audit-reports/annual-comprehensive-financial-reports
F7	PPS 2026-27 adopted budget / superintendent message	https://www.pps.net/departments/budget-grant-accounting/annual-budgets — General Fund and >\$65M future-gap context.
F8	Community Budget Review Committee 2026-27 review	PPS CBRC report; timing, benchmarking, purchased-services and assumptions concerns.
F9	PPS Rumors & Facts / budget process updates	https://media.pps.net/rumors-and-facts — PPS states quarterly CBRC engagement is planned.
D1	PPS October 2025 enrollment summary / data hub	https://www.pps.net/departments/dataaccountability/data-and-accountability/data-strategy-and-insights/data-and-reporting — broad actual series and forecast hub.
D2	PPS graduation subgroup cohort tables	PPS 2024-25 cohort reporting; subgroup and late-entry outcomes.
D3	PPS “Our Academic Journey”	https://www.pps.net/departments/dataaccountability/data-and-accountability/data-strategy-and-insights/our-academic-journey — reading, math, graduation summary.
D4	PPS District Continuous Improvement Plan 2025-2028	https://www.pps.net/about/district-continuous-improvement-plan — attendance, literacy, math, ninth-grade priorities.
D5	PPS Office of Teaching & Learning / Instructional Framework	https://www.pps.net/departments/office-of-teaching-learning/departments-main-page
D6	PPS Data Strategy & Insights	https://www.pps.net/departments/dataaccountability/data-and-accountability/data-strategy-and-insights — existing analytics

ID	Source	Use / limitation
		capacity and forthcoming tracker.
D7	PSU enrollment forecast, July 2025 vintage	PPS-hosted forecast; older vintage illustrates capture recovery already embedded in forecast.
N1	Willamette Week, June 21, 2026 attendance goal/update	https://www.wweek.com/news/schools/2026/06/21/oregon-department-of-education-changes-ppss-attendance-goals/ — preliminary 65.4% regular attendance.
P1	PPS Rightsize, Right Supports, Right for Students hub	https://www.pps.net/about/portland-public-schools-information/rightsize/rightsize — no final decisions at evidence cutoff.
P2	PPS BoardBook, Sept. 1, 2026 meeting materials	Upcoming rightsizing modeling and board discussion.
P3	Willamette Week, Aug. 26, 2026 rightsizing report	https://www.wweek.com/news/schools/2026/08/26/pps-superintendent-says-district-could-close-up-to-20-schools/ — superintendent 10-20 public range; secondary reporting.
L1	PPS PAT agreement page	https://www.pps.net/departments/human-resources/employee-and-labor-relations/pat — agreement in effect through June 30, 2027; 2% salary increase Jan. 1, 2027.
L2	PPS BoardBook, May 26, 2026 Resolution 7306	Board action approving 2026-27 PPS-PAT agreement.
G1	Council of Great City Schools / PPS Student Outcomes Focused Governance material	PPS-hosted governance framework; goals/constraints/accountability role clarity.
G2	PPS leadership / budget administrative personnel	Current public titles used for office-level accountability; names may change.
A1	PPS Multilingual Learners / English Language Development Audit, Feb. 2026	Internal performance audit; nine accepted recommendations and control weaknesses.
A2	PPS OIPA audit index	https://www.pps.net/board/board-of-education/pps-audit-reports/pps-office-of-internal-performance-auditors-oipa — implementation status expected Fall 2026.
S1	Oregon Department of Education special-education funding guidance	https://www.oregon.gov/ode/schools-and-districts/grants/spedfunding/pages/default.aspx — 11% weighting cap and waiver context.
S2	Oregon PERS side accounts	https://www.oregon.gov/pers/pages/general-information/side-accounts-by-the-numbers.aspx — interpret rate credits with financing/debt context.
C1	PPS external bond performance audits index	https://www.pps.net/board/board-of-education/pps-audit-reports/external-bond-performance-audits — audit and implementation history.
R1	Kraft, Schueler & Falken, tutoring meta-analysis (2024)	265 randomized studies; scale-relevant tutoring effects smaller than small pilots.
R2	Kraft, Blazar & Hogan, teacher coaching meta-analysis (2018)	Causal evidence for coaching; scaling and implementation matter.
R3	IES, adaptive parent messaging and attendance (2020)	Reduced chronic absence; no detected one-year academic achievement effect.
R4	IES, Early Warning Intervention and Monitoring System (2017)	Reduced chronic absence/course failure after one year; not a specific PPS graduation

ID	Source	Use / limitation
		forecast.
R5	RAND, Principal Pipelines (2019)	Leadership pipeline evidence across six districts; context and historical costs limit direct PPS translation.
R6	RAND, dual-language immersion in Portland Public Schools (2017)	PPS-specific lottery evidence supporting English-reading gains in studied programs/applicants.
R7	UChicago Consortium, School Closings in Chicago (2018)	Closures are not automatically academic improvements; transition/destination quality matter.
R8	UChicago Consortium, When Schools Close (2009)	Destination quality matters for displaced students.
R9	UChicago Consortium, ninth-grade on-track research	Ninth-grade attendance/course performance are powerful graduation indicators; use with local verification.

Methodological commitments

- Enrollment definitions are never mixed without an explicit bridge: broad headcount, PSU K-12 forecast and ADMw serve different purposes.
- Adopted budgets are plans; periodic reports are forecasts/unaudited actuals; ACFRs are audited historical actuals. They are not interchangeable.
- Fund restrictions are respected. Capital/debt/special-revenue dollars are not described as available General Fund classroom cash.
- Outside research informs expected direction and design; PPS must estimate its own effect through credible evaluation.
- Every scenario says whether it is verified, proposed, reported or illustrative.
- Corrections are part of the product. A credible master plan should become more accurate when district staff, unions, auditors, families or researchers produce better evidence.

THE PPS 2031 DOCTRINE

Promise only what can be funded. Fund what students most need. Verify that the service arrived. Measure whether it worked. Fix the structure before the next crisis.

Every student. Every week. Every dollar.